

IT infrastructure

Being an educational institute, the IT needs of ITM were a bit different and more demanding compared to that of an ordinary organisation. There were typically three kinds of users—the staff, faculty and students/visitors.

The hardware needed by the institution required to focus on providing wired desktops for staff and faculty, while the students' needs were met using Wi-Fi connectivity for their laptops.

The core computing requirement of staff members was office applications, e-mail and Web-based ERP, while the faculty needed additional access to a variety of online resources (EBSCO, PROQUEST and HBR online) and in-house databases (Prowess and Capital Line). An intranet is used for disseminating local information.

The institution uses a mix of branded and assembled servers and client machines. And it uses the laptops of most of the well-known brands, such as Toshiba, IBM, HP, Fujitsu, Acer, etc.

The network infrastructure is completely powered by open source software, and all staff and faculty desktops too use open source applications running on different versions of Fedora. Unfortunately, volume licences of Windows XP Professional and MS Office 2007 Professional are being used for laptops. However, all other pre-loaded

Server stats

The following list gives details of the servers currently in use on the campus:

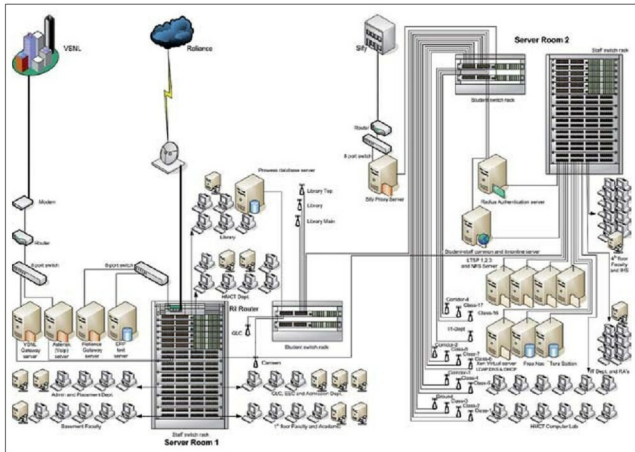
1. DHCP+DNS+LDAP virtual servers (Xen server) in a single physical machine
2. An NFS server (for mounting 'home' folders of all thick clients)
3. Three LTSP servers
4. The RADIUS server (to authenticate the Wi-Fi connections of laptops)
5. An ERP server (on campus for testing purposes and connected to the Internet)
6. A VoIP server
7. A data exchange cum intranet server
8. A student proxy cum DHCP server
9. Two Gateway servers for the staff and faculty
10. A NAS box
11. A prowess offline database server

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1. An ERP server (production)
2. A Web cum mail server

applications on laptops are open source.

The institution uses a mix of thin clients and standalone machines. There are 89 thin clients for



ITM Kharghar network diagram